

## Chapter 172-5

*Journey of the Heart* was positioned as an art film, so on the first day, it had very few screenings.

The first showing was at 9 AM. They hadn't deliberately chosen a meaningful time—it was just released among the many other films.

But because the subject matter was relatively fresh, and Liang Shi's looks were quite good, the poster had a visual advantage among all the films, so some people went to see it.

On the first day, the response was mediocre.

Far from matching "*Let's Go, Right Now.*"

The previous episode's preview had pixelated Liang Shi, but since today's episode was airing, Liang Shi naturally had to promote it with a hashtag. The copy was sent to her by her manager; she just edited it a bit and posted it. She herself was more focused on developments with *Journey of the Heart*.

Unexpectedly, the moment she posted her promotional Weibo, the comment section was invaded.

[Why is it you? Is there some behind-the-scenes manipulation?]

[Resource mooch, get lost.]

[How can you be so shameless?]

[.....]

Almost no positive comments. Her pinned Weibo post was the promotion for *Journey of the Heart*, and her background image was her favorite set of red dress photos from when she went viral.

Netizens cursed all they wanted, cursing her onto the trending list, but her follower count just kept increasing.

With nothing having aired yet, Liang Shi really couldn't defend herself. She could only lie flat and accept the mockery.

Meanwhile, *Journey of the Heart* scored 9.8 on a certain movie platform.

Netizens were shocked.

[How many water armies did they buy?]

[Wait, a Republic-era romance film can score this high? How long has it been since domestic entertainment has seen a good drama?]

[Is a double female lead film really that shippable? This movie has way too many water armies.]

[.....]

No one believed it.

Even though it had been nominated for an international film competition.

But for the domestic audience, it was just an art film made by a director for self-appreciation. What kind of quality could it have? An incomprehensible script plus trippy camerawork, with a bunch of film critics praising it incoherently—it was just self-indulgent emotional gratification.

Works that could resonate with audiences weren't things these artsy types could produce.

From the very beginning, audiences didn't believe in Quella.

But unexpectedly, because of this surreal rating, *Journey of the Heart* trended again.

Everyone refused to believe a bad film could have such a high rating, so with a challenging attitude, they decided to go to the cinema to watch it.

Planning to criticize it with solid evidence after watching.

As a result, tickets for *Journey of the Heart's* second-day screenings were completely booked. A blogger who owned a cinema posted about it, saying they were quite shocked.

Netizens were also quite shocked.

That evening, although the variety show aired, Liang Shi didn't have many shots, and her performance was ordinary. The only thing she was criticized for was directly calling Yang Shuyan by her name, which netizens and Yang Shuyan's fans said was impolite.

Then they dragged Zhao Ying into it, saying what kind of good person could hang out with Zhao Ying?

Liang Shi was already numb to this. She could only message Zhao Ying to apologize for getting her involved.

But Zhao Ying directly posted on Weibo:

@Zhao Ying: I heard Xiao Liang went to the Town of Paradise? Did you try the delicious taro mochi for me? #Let's Go Right Now#

Directly tying them to the same boat.

Liang Shi: .....

Zhao Ying's response to this was: There are so many people cursing at me, a few more doesn't make a difference.

Liang Shi thought, that made sense too, so she just let the netizens do their thing. After all, once you unplugged the internet cable, you couldn't see anything.

That night, she even chatted with Xu Qingzhu: "This online world is too terrifying. I'm being cyber-bullied all the time."

Xu Qingzhu chuckled softly: "Then just don't look. If you think about it, there's an upside too—as long as I can't see it, they're not cursing at me."

Liang Shi: ".....That makes sense!"

However, on the second day, *Journey of the Heart's* rating continued to climb. When it opened for ratings on another platform, the score also kept rising.

Everyone's reviews were also very good.

They had originally thought it would be a cringy romance drama, but ended up being moved one after another.

[I really underestimated Liang Shi's acting. My god, that scene where she cried at the end—my heart shattered.]

[And also, Sun Chengcheng's acting is amazing too! You can't tell at all that they're complete newcomers.]

[I have to say, Quella being hailed as a genius director—she really does have skills. That atmosphere, the eye contact when they first met, that camerawork—I'm literally drooling. It stabbed right into my heart!]

[Before entering the cinema: Let me see just how good this is. After leaving the cinema: Damn! Why is this movie so good!]

[.....]

And so, the third day's screenings were also fully booked, and cinemas began adding more showtimes.

The criticism related to Liang Shi gradually disappeared.

Online, there was even a hashtag: #Apologizing to Liang Shi's Beauty and Acting Skills#.

[Sorry, I was shallow. I thought beautiful people usually couldn't act.]

[I'm shipping them so hard I could die. Is jiejie wearing colored contacts? Her eyes are really so beautiful.]

[You're not a pretty vase—you're a skilled actress! Screaming!]

[.....]

Because there were too many trending topics related to Liang Shi, she and Sun Chengcheng became completely polarized.

Sun Chengcheng's reputation was also good, but her follower growth was far behind Liang Shi's.

In just five days, Liang Shi's follower count had grown to over ten million.

While Sun Chengcheng had less than a million.